Cristian Zappala

Senior Full Stack Developer — .NET · C# · Angular · Microservices · AI-Assisted Development

- **Systems Engineering (Ingeniería en Sistemas) · UAI · 2025**

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SUMMARY

Senior Full Stack Developer with 8+ years building and modernizing business-critical applications in finance, healthcare, energy, pharma, education and enterprise environments. Specialized in .NET/C# backends, Angular front-ends and microservices architectures backed by SQL Server and RabbitMQ.

Specialized in both building new applications from the ground up and modernizing legacy systems without disrupting the business. Comfortable across the full cycle — analysis, solution design, estimation, implementation and production support — in distributed agile teams.

AI is part of my everyday workflow: I use Claude across the whole development cycle — understanding legacy code, design, implementation, refactoring, test writing, code review and documentation — with clear specs and project guidelines that keep AI-generated code consistent and reviewable.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Delivering a national-scale system in a fraction of the estimated time with AI-assisted development.** Assigned by Hiberus to an urgent project, in a three-person team, building a full-stack platform for Argentina's national education assessment (Aprender) that we estimated at over a year of traditional work, on track for delivery in about three months — including client feedback cycles and changes in requirements.
- **Diagnosed and fixed silent message loss in a production purchasing platform.** Took over a critical RabbitMQ issue after the tech lead left, traced it to an architectural flaw where ACKs were sent before processing completed, and restored a purchasing flow that was losing customer orders for Argentina's leading pharmaceutical retailer.
- **Prevented a security-protocol failure from reaching production** by designing and shipping a YARP-based proxy API that isolated the incompatibility, allowing a legacy system to keep operating while modernization continued.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend	.NET / .NET Core, C#, REST APIs, Entity Framework Core, Microservices, Domain-Driven Design, Unit Testing, Design Patterns, YARP, JWT authentication
Frontend	Angular, TypeScript, RxJS, JavaScript, HTML, CSS
Data & Messaging	SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, MSMQ
Cloud & Observability	Azure (App Services, Key Vault, Azure Monitor, Azure DevOps pipelines), Serilog, Kibana, ELK
AI-Assisted Development	Claude — code generation, refactoring, legacy code analysis, test writing, code review, documentation; agent guidelines and spec-driven workflows
Also used (current project)	Python (FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, pytest), React / Next.js, Kubernetes, GitLab CI/CD
Practices & Tools	Scrum, code review, Git / GitHub / GitLab, Jira, technical interviewing
Working knowledge	Docker, CI/CD pipeline configuration, Oracle Database

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Hiberus — Senior Full Stack Developer

Sep 2025 – Present · Consultancy · Buenos Aires, Argentina (Remote)

Aprender 2.0 — Sep 2026 to Present

Urgent, three-person project: management platform for Argentina's national education assessment (reception, scanning control, verification and results of student test booklets).

- Designed the system architecture: a layered REST API (presentation → application → repository abstractions → infrastructure) with FastAPI and async SQLAlchemy, a Next.js/React front-end, and independent processes for image

ingestion, publication and results.

- Led most of the PostgreSQL database design, managed through Alembic migrations.
- Hands-on development across the whole stack: API endpoints with JWT authentication, role-based permissions and auditing; Next.js/React screens for administration, verification and dashboards; RabbitMQ integration with an external scanning provider (images and OMR results); Docker images and GitLab CI/CD deployments to Kubernetes.
- Working with AI-assisted development, the team is delivering in about three months a system estimated at over a year of traditional work, while absorbing client feedback and requirement changes.

Stack: Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, PostgreSQL, Alembic, Next.js, React, TypeScript, TanStack Query, RabbitMQ, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI, pytest, Vitest, Claude

Vital (wholesale retailer) — Sep 2025 to Present

Joined a legacy platform that needed urgent fixes while several business flows required full modernization.

- Proposed and implemented .NET solutions to support and progressively replace legacy operational flows, working with a high level of autonomy across analysis, solution design and estimation.
- Designed and delivered a YARP proxy API that mitigated security-protocol issues before they reached production.
- Use AI (Claude) daily to analyze undocumented legacy code, speed up refactoring and produce technical documentation.
- Coordinate directly with business stakeholders to define scope and priorities for modernization work.

Stack: .NET, C#, YARP, REST APIs, SQL Server, Angular

S3 / Chevron — Senior Full Stack Developer

May 2025 – Aug 2025 · Remote · Contract engagement

Short-term consulting assignment inside an enterprise agile environment.

- Designed and implemented REST APIs in .NET/C# and front-end modules in Angular for enterprise business applications.
- Delivered features through Azure CI/CD pipelines across multiple environments, reducing manual deployment steps and release errors.
- Worked with architects and product owners on scalability and performance decisions, and drove peer review practices for pull requests.

Stack: .NET Core, C#, Entity Framework, Angular, Azure (CI/CD, pipelines), GitHub, Scrum

Hipódromo Argentino de Palermo — Senior Full Stack Developer

May 2024 – May 2025 · Buenos Aires, Argentina · Argentina's main horse-racing venue and betting operator.

- Developed and maintained business-critical applications supporting internal operations and public-facing betting services.
- Designed and optimized SQL Server databases handling high-volume operational and betting data, tuning schemas, indexes and queries for reliable performance under peak load.
- Integrated internal and third-party systems through APIs and web services.
- Introduced centralized logging and monitoring with Serilog, Kibana and Elasticsearch, cutting down the time needed to identify and troubleshoot production incidents.

Stack: .NET Core, C#, Entity Framework, Angular, WinForms, SQL Server, Redis, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, Docker, GitHub, Jira

Softensity — Senior Full Stack Developer

Feb 2022 – May 2024 · US-based consultancy (Remote)

Care Guide — Sep 2023 to May 2024

Platform connecting older adults with care communities and geriatric services.

- Built and maintained features in a microservices platform using .NET/C# and Angular, applying Domain-Driven Design.
- Worked with cross-functional product teams to translate care-provider requirements into shipped product improvements.

EY — Feb 2022 to Sep 2023

US accounting and tax platform.

- Developed and maintained backend services and Angular front-end features for a US accounting platform.
- Worked in Scrum with distributed teams across the United States, Brazil, Belarus, India and Turkey.

- Contributed beyond delivery: conducted technical interviews for the company, launched internal training initiatives on new technologies, and represented the team in an internal AI contest.

Stack: .NET Core, C#, Entity Framework, Microservices, DDD, Angular, SQL Server, Azure (CI/CD, Key Vault), Docker, GitHub

Hexacta — Full Stack Developer

Aug 2019 – Jan 2022 · Buenos Aires, Argentina · Microservices purchasing platform for Argentina's leading pharmaceutical retailer.

- Took ownership of a critical RabbitMQ failure after the technical lead left the team, investigating message loss that was silently affecting user purchases.
- Identified an architectural flaw where ACKs were sent before successful processing; redesigned the consumer flow and eliminated the loss, protecting a core revenue path.
- Designed and maintained microservices for purchase-order management, collaborating with stakeholders on pharma-specific requirements.

Stack: .NET Core, C#, Entity Framework, Microservices, RabbitMQ, Angular, SQL Server, MongoDB, Azure (CI/CD), GitHub

Nosis — Full Stack Developer

Jan 2018 – Aug 2019 · Buenos Aires, Argentina · Credit bureau and financial information provider.

- Led end-to-end development of a system displaying brands together with tax identifiers and financial data, from requirements to production.
- Built a dedicated microservice and a .NET importer feeding Elasticsearch, enabling fast search across the company's brand and tax-identifier dataset.
- Delivered software under strict reliability and security requirements for sensitive financial data.

Stack: .NET, C#, Microservices, REST APIs, WinForms, SQL Server, Elastic Stack, MSMQ, JavaScript, jQuery

EDUCATION

Systems Engineering (Ingeniería en Sistemas) — Universidad Abierta Interamericana (UAI) · Graduated 2025

Additional: Aircraft Aeronautical Technician (MMA), E.E.S.T. Nº 7 · Radio Electric Equipment Aircraft Technician (MERA), INAC-CIATA